ZATCA · Phase 2

4 things about ZATCA integration nobody tells you

I learned them building an e-invoicing engine solo, all the way through the real production gateway.



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Who needs this

SAR 187,500

The Wave 25 threshold. Deadline: 1 February 2027

Any business above this in taxable revenue in any year from 2022 to 2025.
That means a lot of businesses integrating for the first time.



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1

Your Arabic address can vanish from the CSR

In my build, openssl dropped the Arabic address field and the ones after it.
No error, and the CSR was rejected.



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2

A sandbox pass proves nothing

The test environment isn't production.
Don't say "done" until the production certificate is issued
and the first real invoice clears.



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3

Don't touch the XML after the hash

Any reformatting after you compute the hash means it won't match.
And ZATCA rejects the invoice.



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4

An unsent invoice has to give its number back

The invoice counter (ICV) has to run in order, with no gaps.
Cancel an invoice before sending without returning its number,
and you leave a gap ZATCA reviews later.



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Save this

Before you say "integration done"

1. Test an Arabic address in the CSR
2. Sign after the last change to the XML
3. Put a unique index on the counter
4. If the totals don't add up, reject the invoice. Don't guess.



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I'm Mohammed. I build products, and the machine that sells them, from Riyadh.

Save this, and tell me in the comments:
which ZATCA error held you up the longest?



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